

LAURA ELLISON

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Portfolio: leopardesign.com/portfolio • LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/lauraellison • Corp: leopardesign.com

UX Design/Architect/Strategy Lead | Enterprise SaaS B2B | eCommerce B2C | Digital Transformation
High-Profile Product Launches | V1 & MVP Releases | Regulated Industries | Salesforce | Automotive OEM

UX Design Lead and Incorporated Consultant leading own firm, Leopard Design, Inc., specializing in digital transformation of complex Enterprise/SaaS & eCommerce apps within heavily regulated industries. US Citizen.

- **Strategic consultant** with strong business acumen and a bias for action. Solid communicator with excellent communication, negotiation, and interpersonal skills.
- **Pragmatic mindset** with the ability to simplify complex business processes into simple, intuitive interfaces. Realist with respectful, professional demeanor, who delivers projects on time and on budget.
- **Self-starter and quick study**, with the ability to hit the ground running and deliver results, even in new or uncertain environments. Straight-shooter who knows how to get things done.
- **Collaborative team leader** who works with product management, engineering, research, marketing, creative (visual designers & copywriters), executive management, and business partners.
- **Detail-oriented subject matter expert** with sensitivity to user challenges. Passionate about meeting business goals, while keeping needs and preferences of end user front and center.

CORPORATE VISION

Ultimately, for enterprise, the mission is about getting business done. No one goes to an enterprise app to be entertained. My projects all have a business focus, whether it's B2B or B2C. I help companies translate their business goals into reality. – Laura Ellison

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

Mobile/Tablet & Devices: iOS (iPhone & iPad) | Android (Phone & Tablet) | Wearables (wearable devices) | IoT | eReader Tablets (NOOK; consumer electronics) | mWeb (Mobile Web) & Mobile First Design | Responsive/Adaptive Web (Mobile, Tablet & Desktop)

Design/UX Software: Figma | Sketch | Miro | Zeplin | Component Libraries | WCAG 2.2 & Section 508 (ADA) | Photoshop | Illustrator | Adobe Creative Cloud | Axure | Omnigraffle

Operating Systems & Platforms: Salesforce Lightning (SLDS) | Responsive/Adaptive Web | Cloud (Commerce, Services, Financial Services, Sales) | CPQ | iOS | Android | Mac/OSX | Windows | Agile & Waterfall Methodologies

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Leopard Design, Inc. | California + Nevada | leopardesign.com

1998 – Present

UX Design Consultancy founded as C-Corporation in both California and Nevada in 2000, assisting clients to translate ideas and business goals into actual app launches.

Founder / Principal / UX Design Consultant

Serve as UX Design/Architect/Strategy Lead Consultant for Enterprise/SaaS/B2B and eCommerce/B2C projects. Assist clients from Fortune 100 to start-ups, in reducing costs, increasing revenues, and attaining strategic business goals. Modernize older apps and build new apps to achieve business objectives.

- **Led successful product launches** for V1 and MVP releases for iOS, Android, Responsive & Salesforce apps.
- **Digital transformation** of complex SaaS products for high-profile Enterprise clients.

- **Experienced in regulated industries** including Automotive, Financial Services & FinTech, Insurance, Medical Devices & Biotech, Legal, HR, Utilities, Consumer Electronics, Hospitality, SMBs, Cybersecurity, and Big Tech.
- **Notable companies:** Toyota, NetApp, Walmart, Cisco, eBay, Sephora, Barnes & Noble, eBay, Cisco, Investors Business Daily, PRO Unlimited, Genentech, Williams-Sonoma, PG&E, WWT, and Silicon Valley startups.

PRIOR EXPERIENCE | AUTOMOTIVE

Ford Motor Company | Metro Detroit Area (*onsite*)

6 years

Program Manager & Executive Assistant (*Contractor*):

- **Managed OEM international prototype engine build program** between Ford N.A. Engineering Centers in Dearborn, MI, and with Ford of Europe Engineering Centers in Dunton, England and Cologne, Germany.
- **Managed 2.5L Duratec V6 Porsche/European engine program** (Mondeo V6, first generation).
- **Led cross-functional team meetings** (management, engineering & Tier-1 Suppliers) to resolve issues in design changes, inspections, and parts delivery.
- **Monitored project status** and published program management reports.

EDUCATION

Master of Arts (MA)–Applied Economics | Eastern Michigan University | *Ypsilanti, MI*

- **Coursework:** Quantitative Statistical Methods | Regression Analysis | Empirical Research Methods | Data Mining & Relational Databases | Mathematical Model Building | Detailed Written Analysis | Human Factors (Social Science)

Bachelor of Arts (BA)–Art History | University of Michigan-Dearborn | *Dearborn, MI*

- Internships at The Detroit Institute of Arts (DIA) and Habatat Galleries (glass sculpture)

Bachelor of Arts (BA)–Economics & Minor in Business | University of Michigan-Dearborn | *Dearborn, MI*

German Language Coursework | Technische Universität Braunschweig | *Braunschweig, Germany*

French Language Coursework | Promolangue | *Paris, France*

AFFILIATIONS

Member, BayCHI, www.baychi.org (Chapter of ACM SIGCHI on Computer-Human Interaction) 2000–Present

ONLINE PORTFOLIO

TOYOTA: leopardesign.com/toyota

- Digital transformation of disparate legacy Dealer SaaS/Enterprise apps using Salesforce Lightning (SLDS).
- Brand tenants included: Mazda, Toyota/Lexus, and Bass Pro Shops.

NETAPP: leopardesign.com/netapp

- V1 Release of Oracle Cloud CPQ-based application (Oracle JET UI) to replace legacy quoting app.
- CPQ (Configure, Price, Quote) is a SaaS cloud commerce solution serving both Internal (Sales) and External (Partners) users, enabling approximately \$6B in annual revenues.

PG&E: leopardesign.com/pge

- Personalization of online customer experience (CX) led to ~96,000 fewer customer calls.
- Achieved 75%+ sign-up rate for high-profile V1 waive deposit feature for new customers, far exceeding expectations, by designing approachable UX with “three easy steps.”

HOT SCHEDULES: leopardesign.com/hotschedules

- MVP inventory SaaS/Enterprise app for restaurant/regional managers of mid/large-sized restaurant chains.

PROUNLIMITED: leopardesign.com/prounlimited

- V1 Release iPhone SaaS/Enterprise app, WAND. Most-used features for Fortune 100 managers sourcing talent on-the-go, plus some features for workers.

GODADDY: leopardesign.com/godaddy

- V1 Release International Business Email for emerging markets. Productivity solutions for small and medium businesses (SMBs) plus mid-market (MM) Customers.

NOTABLE PROJECTS

Below is a partial list of notable projects, among many from a consistent work schedule throughout career. Shorter projects with small businesses and start-ups are not listed and are available upon request.

Symetra | Seattle, WA (Remote)

September – December 2025 (4-months)

UX Design Lead | Benefits Integration Platform | Consultant

Symetra is a financial services company offering annuities, life insurance and employee benefits.

*Hired as **UX Design Lead** Consultant on shorter-term, high-profile **Benefits Integration Platform** (BIP) used by Admins, Implementors and Processors. Recent business acquisition meant 4x data feeds upcoming to BIP app—requiring professional UX to efficiently handle increased workflow (or risk losing business).*

- **Designed disciplined UX solutions to complex, data-dense application** (nested tables, charts, controls, etc.) in collaboration with SME financial services stakeholders for Benefits Integration Platform (BIP).
- **Dashboard data visualization analytics** included graphs, trend lines, etc. (real-time & historical) with custom designed controls (dropdowns, search, date-ranges, chart styles, etc.) for Admins & Processors.
- Goal to provide **timely, accurate, easy-access group benefits information** to Admins, Implementors & Processors in **facilitating critical decision-making in management/implementation/processing**.
- **Figma prototypes** for stakeholders, executives, and engineering.

Beckman Coulter | Brea, CA (Remote)

October 2023 – September 2025 (2-years)

UX Design Lead | EHR SaaS | Consultant

Beckman Coulter is a medical device manufacturer and global leader in advanced diagnostics.

*Hired as **UX Design Lead** Consultant for high-profile **SMART on FHIR** within **EHR** (Electronic Health Records) **SaaS** application used by doctors and nurses for new feature on Sepsis Risk. UX Designs required to pass **FDA Regulatory Compliance**.*

- **Designed disciplined UX solutions to very complex, data-dense SMART on FHIR** within **EHR** application in collaboration with scientific stakeholders, for new feature on patient Sepsis Risk.
- **Complex data visualization analytics** included graphs, trend lines, etc., both real-time and historical.
- Goal to provide timely, accurate, easy-access diagnostic information to doctors/nurses on patient SepsisRisk, to **facilitate critical decision-making on diagnosis and treatment**.
- **Figma prototypes** for user testing with doctors/nurses prior to **submission for FDA Compliance**.

Thomson Reuters: Elite Technology | Eagan, MN (Remote)

August – November 2023 (4-months)

Experience Design Lead | Consultant

Hired as an **Experience Design Lead** Consultant within **Elite Technology** (subsidiary of Thomson Reuters) for **high-profile, digital transformation of legacy SaaS Financial and Practice Management software for Law Firms**. Projects scaled-back due to **budget cutbacks across the board** followed by staff layoffs.

- **Designed strategic improvements to the UX** in collaboration with Legal Product Managers.
- From **pain points so bad**, customers were calling HQ to complain—to “Wow, this is great!” solutions.
- **Advocated optimal color choices** for notifications/icons/etc for better legibility + **color-blind ADA accessibility compliance**.
- Features included **Billable Hours**, Time Models, Always-On-Time, Weekly Time Lists, etc.

AssuredPartners | Orlando, FL (Remote)

January – July 2023 (7-months)

UX Design Lead | Salesforce CRM | Consultant

Hired as a **UX Design Lead** Consultant for **high-profile, Salesforce CRM (Financial Services Cloud) for Insurance Producers, Sales Leaders, and Agency Presidents**, using **Salesforce Lightning Design System (SLDS)**. MVP approved for production environment.

Large-scale initiative team comprised of AssuredPartners employees, external consulting firms (including Salesforce) and independent consultants. Goal to have Salesforce CRM help users sell more/faster while managing opportunities, leads, contacts, closed/won status, reports, etc. Projects scaled-back due to **budget cutbacks across the board**.

- **Designed clean, modern UX solutions** to complex Producers/Sales business requirements, while adhering to **Salesforce Lightning** style guidelines.
- **Optimized Homepage to UX Best Practices**, including logic/order of components, ease-of-use, etc.
- **Advocated optimal color choices** for notifications & charts/graphs/tables for better legibility + **color-blind ADA accessibility compliance**.
- **Recommended strategic improvements to the UX design** (within real world constraints of time/budget & Salesforce constraints) in collaboration with Product/Engineering stakeholders.

Toyota Motor North America | Plano, TX (Remote)

August 2021 – August 2022 (1-year)

Experience Design Lead | Salesforce | Consultant | Portfolio: leopardesign.com/toyota

Hired as an **Experience Design Lead** Consultant within TFS Digital for **high-profile, large-scale digital transformation of legacy Dealer and Agent/Finance SaaS/Enterprise apps** across Mazda, Toyota/Lexus, and BassPro brand tenants, using **Salesforce Financial Services Cloud (FSC)**.

Large-scale initiative team comprised of Toyota employees, external consulting firms (Infosys, Photon) and independent consultants. Goal to create **consistent, unified digital experience** (replacing disparate legacy apps) for ease of use and improved efficiencies.

Project went on hold due to budget cutbacks across the board amid supply chain turbulences on quarterly results (42% drop operating profit, Q1), revised full-year guidance.

- **Designed clean, modern UX solutions** to complex Dealer and Agent/Finance FinTech business requirements, while adhering to **Salesforce Lightning Design System (SLDS)** style guidelines.
- **Recommended strategic improvements to the UX design** (within real world constraints of time and budget) in collaboration with Digital Factory Team Owners.
- **Negotiated critical buy-in from Business stakeholders** by presenting choices of UX design solutions, opening their mindset to trying new ideas.
- **Advocated optimal color choices** for notifications for better legibility + **color-blind ADA accessibility compliance**.

- **Collaborated with Engineering** via JIRA Issues filed, to ensure faithful implementation of designs.

Cyborg Mobile | Greater Seattle Area (*Remote*)

April – September 2021 (*5-months*)

UX Strategist/Researcher | Freelance Consultant

Hired as a **UX Strategist** Consultant to conduct **Heuristic Evaluation** of enterprise training application, for both Admins and Learners users.

- **Recommended strategic organizational improvements** to application, enabling a more "turnkey operation" for Admins, while still allowing flexibility/autonomy, plus maintaining compliance.

Hired as **UX Researcher** Consultant on **UX Discovery** project for confidential client. UX Research included:

- **Comparative Research** on guided filtering, filtering within disparate inventory, product exploration, product customization, and product recommendations based on user-questionnaire, plus interviews with targeted customers.

NetApp | Sunnyvale, CA (*Hybrid*)

August 2019 – May 2020 (*10-months*)

UX Design Lead | CPQ | Consultant | Portfolio: leopardesign.com/netapp

Hired as UX Design Lead Consultant for **high-profile V1 CPQ (Configure, Price, Quote) app** (Oracle Cloud CPQ + Oracle JET UI: latest technology, greater agility, and improved performance) to eventually replace legacy QuoteEdge app.

Large-scale SaaS initiative CPQ Team comprised of NetApp employees, external consulting firm Pierce-Washington, and independent consultants. CPQ is a cloud commerce solution serving both Internal (Sales) and External (Partners) users, enabling approximately \$6B in annual revenues. **Project went on hold due to funding freeze** on subsequent Price and Quote segments due to COVID-19.

- **Designed clean, modern UX solutions** to complex CPQ business requirements, while accommodating Oracle JET UI technical constraints.
- **Recommended refined improvements** to UX design solutions in collaboration with CPQ Team.
- **Conducted Usability Testing** with both Internal (Sales) and External (Partners) to validate UX Design solutions, and uncover any undiscovered pain points.
- **Collaborated with Engineering** via Azure Issues filed, to ensure faithful implementation of design.
- **Led successful Phase 1 launch of Configure** in June 2020.

Pacific Gas & Electric Co. (PG&E) | San Ramon, CA (*Onsite*)

February – December 2018 (*11-months*)

CX Design/Architect Lead | Consultant | Portfolio: leopardesign.com/pge

Hired as Customer Experience (CX) Design/Architect Lead with **World Wide Technology (WWT) Consulting** for **high-visibility** customer-facing web apps at PG&E. Projects included: waive deposit, start/stop/transfer, payments (recurring, one-time, multiple), bill protection (time-of-use rate plans), paperless billing, and third party authorizations.

- **Achieved 75%+ sign-up rate for high-profile V1 waive deposit feature** for new customers, far exceeding expectations, by designing approachable UX with "three easy steps."
- **Attained turnaround of 45% drop-off rates** in online Start/Stop/Transfer requests by streamlining app, eliminating non-essential requirements.
- **Increased payment arrangements 30%** via implementation of online recurring payments for checking/savings and new debit/credit card options.
- **Successfully passed strict WCAG 2.2 / Section 508 Compliance (ADA Testing)** prior to launch, as requirement for customer-facing apps.

- **Led successful launches of V1 Waive Deposit, recurring payments, and start/stop/transfer.**
Personalization of online customer experience (CX) led to ~96,000 fewer customer calls.

HotSchedules | San Francisco, CA (Hybrid)

March – June 2017 (4-months)

UX Design/Architect Lead | Consultant | Portfolio: leopardesign.com/hotschedules

Hired as UX Design/Architect Lead for **high-visibility MVP Responsive Enterprise app**, cloud-based Inventory solutions for restaurant managers and regional managers of medium/large-sized restaurant chains.

HotSchedules offers the Restaurant Management Platform, **SaaS** enterprise suite, for improving operations and reducing costs in the Hospitality industry.

- **Developed minimum viable product (MVP features) in agile environment** by leading global cross-functional strategy team with product managers.
- **Devised successful system-compliant and user-friendly solution** by pinpointing shortcomings in count variance information displayed. Leveraged experience as a QuickBooks accounting software user.
- **Advocated optimal color choices** for dashboard notifications/indicators for better legibility + **color-blind ADA accessibility compliance**.
- **Inventory features included:** Ordering, Receiving, Count, Adjustments, Transfers, Recipes, etc.
- **Successful MVP launch** of Inventory.

GoDaddy | Sunnyvale, CA (Hybrid)

June – October 2016 (4-months)

UX Architect Lead | Consultant | Portfolio: leopardesign.com/godaddy

Hired as UX Architect Lead for **high-profile work-in-progress SaaS initiatives**, covering for an employee taking planned maternity leave. **Successfully managed on-schedule launch of V1 International Business Email for emerging markets** (Brazil, Mexico, Turkey & India; **mobile first design**), plus other projects.

GoDaddy offers Productivity Solutions for Small & Medium Business (SMB) and Mid-Market (MM) Customers. As a small business owner myself, I brought additional insights to the table beyond my core UX Design expertise.

- **Strategized with Product Managers** in brainstorming sessions to construct innovative solutions to complex issues (i.e., encouraging O365 customers to upgrade their plan, balancing detailed info with overview comparison of plans).
- **Design Thinking + Business Acumen = Innovative Solutions.** Uncovered shortcomings in International Business Email setup and devised user-friendly and informative solutions.
- **Collaborated with Development Teams** in Agile/Scrum environment. **Served as liaison** with Visual Designers and Copywriters.
- **Made recommendations on how to better serve Mac customers**, as email upgrades/transfers were PC/Windows-centric.
- **Productivity solutions included:** [InApp/Mailbox Upgrades](#) (Office 365 Plans), [Value AddOns](#) (Encryption, Archiving, HIPAA compliant), [Inorganic Migrations](#) (customers from acquired service providers), [Workspace Upgrades](#) (to Office 365), etc.
- **Orchestrated successful V1 launch of International Business Email** for emerging markets.

PRO Unlimited | San Francisco, CA (Hybrid)

May 2013 – February 2014 (10-months)

UX Design/Architect Lead | Consultant | Portfolio: leopardesign.com/prounlimited

PRO Unlimited is a Managed Services Provider (MSP) in the contingent workforce space. Well-known Fortune 500 companies use WAND SaaS to procure and manage billions of dollars of contingent workforce spend.

Hired as UX Design/Architect Lead for **high-profile V1 Enterprise iPhone app**, WAND, to identify most-used features for Fortune 100 Managers to source talent on-the-go, and identify desired features for workers. Collaborated with external consulting firm to ensure project success.

- **Turned around troubled project in aftermath of outside consulting firm being let go** by collaborating with product management. Accelerated timeframe in project completion post-turnaround.
- **Designed detailed annotated wireframes** based on user and business requirements, including legal and regulatory constraints.
- **Ensured alignment by giving all screens unique alpha-numeric codes** for complex wireframes.
- **Enabled creation of corresponding iPad and Android versions of WAND**, by allowing team to leverage use of my V1 iPhone wireframes.
- **Led successful V1 launch** with WAND iPhone app becoming **highest-rated app in the industry!**

EARLIER PROJECTS

Sephora | San Francisco, CA (Hybrid) 5-months

UX Design/Architect Lead | Consultant | V1 Release: iPhone

eBay | San Jose, CA (Remote) 5-months

Senior UX Designer/Architect | Consultant | Android Updates

Barnes & Noble | Palo Alto, CA (Onsite) 5-months

Senior UX/Product Designer | Consultant | V1 Release: Nook Tablet (Android)

Walmart Global eCommerce | Brisbane, CA (Onsite) 6-months

Senior Mobile UX Architect | Consultant | V1 Releases: iOS/Android/mWeb

Genentech | South San Francisco, CA (Onsite) 8-months

Lead UX Design/Architect & UX Researcher | Consultant | SaaS Commercial Portal

Investor's Business Daily | Los Angeles, CA (Hybrid) 2-months

UX Researcher | Freelance Consultant | Financial High-Traffic Site

NeoScale Systems | Milpitas, CA (Hybrid) 1-year 7-months

Lead UX Architect & GUI/Visual Designer | Consultant | V1 SaaS Security/Encryption Apps

Cisco Systems | San Jose, CA (Hybrid) 8-months

Lead Information Architect & UI/UX Designer | Consultant | V2 Quote-to-Cash